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Break In

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16 December 2019, Vijay Diwas

I was lying in bed in the morning, going over the day's programme. A dinner that evening was planned with Admiral Karambir Singh, 24th Chief of the Naval Staff (CNS), at Navy House on Rajaji Marg, New Delhi. It was a farewell dinner from his side for General Rawat. I remember thinking to myself that if some announcement were made today, and if well-wishers started coming to our official residence at 25, Safdarjung Road, it might become difficult to get away. As it turned out, the announcement was made only when we were already at Navy House. We were already seated for dinner when Lieutenant Kapil, the Aide-de-Camp to the CNS, came up to me, saying that my Military Assistant (MA), Brig Vikrant Naik, wanted to speak to me. Since I was not carrying my mobile, Vikrant had to call the Flags, as the aides are called in the Navy. I went in to take the call, and that's when Vikrant conveyed the news that I had, in fact, been appointed as the next Army Chief. He also put me through to the Private Secretary to

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